



JAMAICA CONSTABULARY FORCE ORDERS

*'We Serve'
'We Protect'
'We Reassure'*

8TH SEPTEMBER, 2016

SERIAL NO. 3614

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PART I - ADMINISTRATION AND NOTIFICATIONS

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Sub. No. 1 MALE HEALTH - PROSTATE CANCER

The Medical Services Branch has provided the following article for general information.

The prostate is a gland found only in males. It is located in front of the rectum and below the urinary bladder. The size of the prostate varies with age. In younger men, it is about the size of a walnut and has the shape of an unopened ackee, but it can be much larger in older men.

The prostate's job is to make some of the fluid that protects and nourishes sperm cells in semen, making the semen more liquid. Just behind the prostate are glands called *seminal vesicles* that make most of the fluid for semen. The *urethra*, which is the tube that carries urine and semen out of the body through the penis, goes through the center of the prostate.

Prostate cancer is the second most frequently diagnosed cancer in the world and the leading cause of cancer in men in Jamaica. The chances of developing the disease increase as men get older: more than 70% of cases are found in men over 65 years of age. Prostate cancer usually grows slowly and if detected early, it is considered as highly treatable. However, some types of prostate cancer grow quickly and involve other areas of the body, such as bones. When this happens the chance of successful treatment becomes less.

Signs and Symptoms

There are usually no signs or symptoms in the early stages of the disease.

Other signs of disease confined to prostate gland may include;

- Frequent urination
- Decreased urine flow
- Difficulty delaying urination
- Blood in urine

The signs and symptoms listed below may be seen when the disease is advanced.

Symptoms and signs include:

- Sudden decrease in volume and force of urinary stream
- Painful or frequent urination(especially at nights)
- Painful ejaculation
- Blood in urine or semen
- Pain in back, hips, thighs or shoulders that does not go away
- Weight loss and unexplained extreme tiredness

Screening

Prostate cancer may be detected early by having a digital (gloved finger) rectal (back passage) examination (DRE) done by a medical doctor and taking a blood test called Prostate Specific Antigen (PSA). It is recommended that you consult your doctor regarding the age you should start screening for prostate cancer and the frequency of having these tests. The general recommendation is for annual screening from age of 40 years old. Screening can be arranged by contacting your general practitioner, Jamaica Cancer Society and the Jamaica Constabulary Force Medical Services Branch, at telephone number 749-5268.

Prevention

The exact cause of prostate cancer is not known at this time, thus making prevention not easily achievable. Some risk factors such as age, race and family history cannot be prevented. However, there are some risk factors which if controlled can lower the risk of prostate cancer.

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FORCE ORDERS (CONT'D)

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MALE HEALTH - PROSTATE CANCER (CONT'D)

- Overweight associated with a slightly lower risk of prostate cancer overall but a higher rate of fatal prostate cancer
- High physical activity decreases risk of prostate cancer
- Diet high in vegetables such as tomatoes, soy, beans, legumes, cabbage, cauliflower and broccoli or fish may lower risk of prostate cancer

Treatment

If screening test comes back positive (suggest presence of prostate cancer) then your doctor will do further test to determine if the signs and symptoms are due to prostate cancer or other non-cancerous conditions. If prostate cancer is confirmed there will be different treatment options which you will have to discuss with your doctor. Urologists are doctors who specialize in the treatment of prostate cancer.

Information cited in this article is derived from Jamaica Cancer Society and West Indian Medical Journal.

Sub. No. 2

WORLD PHYSICAL THERAPY WEEK - SEPTEMBER 4-9, 2016

What is Physical Therapy?

Physical therapy provides services to individuals and populations to develop, maintain and restore maximum movement and functional ability throughout their lifespan. This includes providing services in circumstances where movement and function are threatened by ageing, injury, pain, diseases, disorders, conditions or environmental factors. Functional movement is central to what it means to be healthy.

Physical therapy is concerned with identifying and maximizing quality of life and movement potential within the spheres of promotion, prevention, treatment/intervention, habilitation and rehabilitation. This encompasses physical, psychological, emotional, and social wellbeing. Physical therapy involves the interaction between the physical therapist, patients/clients, other health professionals, families, care givers and communities in a process where movement potential is assessed and goals are agreed upon, using knowledge and skills unique to physical therapists.

Who is a Physical Therapist?

Physical therapists have different titles in different countries: in many countries they are called physiotherapists.

Physical therapists provide services that develop, maintain and restore people's maximum movement and functional ability. They can help people at any stage of life, when movement and function are threatened by ageing, injury, diseases, disorders, conditions or environmental factors.

Physical therapists help people maximize their quality of life, looking at physical, psychological, emotional and social wellbeing. They work in the health spheres of promotion, prevention, treatment/intervention, habilitation and rehabilitation.

Common Conditions Treated

Some of the conditions treated by physical therapists include: stroke, pneumonia, asthma, bronchitis, arthritis, strains and sprains, fractures, neck and back pain, spinal cord injury, parkinson's disease, bell's palsy, peripheral nerve injuries, post amputations, burns, decubitus ulcers, psoriasis, pelvic inflammatory disease, ante- and post-natal rehabilitation, pre-and post-operative management, etc.

FORCE ORDERS (CONT'D)

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WORLD PHYSICAL THERAPY WEEK - SEPTEMBER 4-9, 2016 (CONT'D)

How to access Physical Therapy Management

In Jamaica persons have to get a referral from a medical doctor in order to receive physical therapy management.

The Jamaica Constabulary Force (JCF) established a Physical Therapy section in the Medical Services Branch in 2009. Physical therapy is offered to members (sworn and unsworn) of the JCF and their immediate relatives (i.e. declared spouse and children). It is free of cost and opens Monday to Friday 8am-4pm.

Contact:
JCF Physiotherapy Department
Twickenham Park
St. Catherine
Tel: 749-6756

Sub. No. 3 REMINDER - A PRACTICAL APPROACH TO COMMITTAL PROCEEDINGS

Force Orders No. 3593, Part I, Sub. No. 7 dated 2016-04-14, is hereby republished for general information.

Introduction

Effective immediately, the procedure outlined hereunder must be adopted by every member of the Jamaica Constabulary Force (JCF) who is involved in the investigation of Indictable Offences which may be tried in the High Court. This is in keeping with the requirements of the Committal Proceedings Act 2013 and the Committal Proceedings Rule, 2015 which came into operation on January 1, 2016, vide The Jamaica Gazette, Vol. CXXXVIII dated Monday, December 28, 2015. The Committal Proceedings Act abolishes preliminary examinations and establishes Committal Proceedings.

The presumption under Committal Proceedings is that witnesses will not be required to attend Court to give evidence for a determination to be made whether an accused should stand trial in the High Court for the offence with which he is charged.

The statements and exhibits, presented by the prosecutor, will suffice providing there are no deficiencies in the statements or the management of the exhibits, rendering the evidence inadmissible.

Whilst, the benefits to the Justice System are quite stark, it places greater obligation on the JCF to ensure that cases are properly and thoroughly investigated.

Purpose

This policy seeks to achieve a standard approach in the investigation of Indictable Offences to which Committal Proceedings apply and is supplemental to the Crime Reporting and Case Management Policy.

Authority

The Committal Proceedings Act 2013, (hereinafter referred to as the "Act") and the Committal Proceedings Rules 2015 (hereinafter referred to as the "Rules").

FORCE ORDERS (CONT'D)

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REMINDER - A PRACTICAL APPROACH TO COMMITTAL PROCEEDINGS (CONT'D)

Scope

This Policy applies to every member of the JCF investigating Indictable Offences or connected to the investigation of these offences, and in particular, the recording of witness statements. This includes the recording of statements by members of the JCF in cases where they are witnesses. It does not apply to expert reports, confession statements, questions and answers and dying declarations.

Enforceable Officer

In keeping with the Crime Reporting and Case Management Policy, Crime Officers must ensure that all cases submitted to the Court are in compliance with the Act and the Rules, unless an exception under paragraph 16 hereunder (recording/ writing of statements) applies.

Policy Statement

In line with the Overriding Objective of the Committal Proceedings Rules, this policy embodies the commitment of the JCF, in recognition of its mandate in the Justice system to ensure that Committal Proceedings proceed as swiftly as is reasonably possible and consistent with a fair and just process, by fostering strict compliance with the process. It is therefore imperative that the JCF, as initiators of investigations and the prosecutorial process, make every effort to achieve the objectives of the Act and the Rules.

As such, in keeping with the law and best practices, all witness statements in committable cases must comply with the Act (*Except paragraph 16 hereunder applies, relating to the recording of statements*) and case files prepared and submitted in a timely manner to permit disclosure to the Court and the defence within the time line specified in the Rules.

In addition, the rights of the accused must always be observed whilst maintaining and improving the JCF's investigative capacity.

Definition

Preliminary Report as defined by the Rules, is now the CR15 which should be completed by the investigating officer and approved by the Crime Officer or the Divisional Detective Inspector (DDI) or the Vetting Officer (VO) and submitted to the Prosecutor/Clerk of Court with the case file.

Investigating Officer (IO): Any member of the JCF (members of the Rural Police not included) who is assigned to conduct investigation into Indictable Offence to which Committal Proceedings apply.

Indictable Offence: Any serious offence that may be tried in the Circuit Court.

Procedure

I. Recording/writing of statements

Where an **Indictable Offence** has been committed or suspected to have been committed, the following procedures shall be adapted in the recording of statements:

1. The statement must be recorded whether in writing or by electronic means by a member of the Jamaica Constabulary Force (hereafter referred to as JCF) (District Constables are excluded) in the presence of a **Justice of the Peace** (hereafter referred to as JP) or in the absence of a JP, a member of the JCF of or above the rank of a **Sergeant**.